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DutyDesk

User Guide — Customs Tariff Classification & Tax Advice

PAS Trinidad Brokerage Department

Step-by-step instructions for clerks using DutyDesk to upload supplier invoices, classify goods against the T&T tariff, calculate customs duty and VAT, and send tax advice to consignees.

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1. Introduction

DutyDesk is a web application for Trinidad & Tobago customs brokerage clerks. It helps you:

- Upload commercial invoices (PDF or scanned images)
- Extract line items automatically using AI
- Match products to official **T&T tariff codes** (6,000+ entries)
- Calculate **import duty, VAT, CIF**, and container fees
- Generate and send **tax advice** to consignees by email or WhatsApp
- Share consignee records and sent worksheets across the team

DutyDesk runs in your browser. Your team shares one database for consignees, exchange rates, and classification history. Invoice data in your current session is cleared when you sign out.

2. Signing in

1. Open your DutyDesk URL in Chrome, Edge, or Firefox.
2. Enter your **username** and **password** provided by your administrator.
3. Click **Sign in**.

Tip: On first login, change the default admin password if your site still uses the factory credentials. Contact your administrator for account setup.

Sign out (top right) clears invoice data stored in your browser for privacy. Team consignees and sent reports remain in the shared database.

3. Navigation overview

Hover over any tab in the top navigation bar to see a short description of that section.

Tab	Purpose
Upload	Add supplier invoices (PDF, JPG, PNG). AI extracts line items.
Review	Verify tariff codes, prices, and invoice totals before tax calculation.
Manual	Add items one at a time without uploading a full invoice.

Tab	Purpose
Taxes	Calculate duty, VAT, CIF; print or send tax advice.
Brokerage	Estimate brokerage service fees from CIF value.
ASYCUDA	Prepare approved figures for customs entry.
Learned	View tariff codes the team has saved from past classifications.
Reports	History of tax advice sent — synced across clerks.
Users Admin	Manage clerk and admin accounts.

On mobile, use the bottom navigation bar for the same tabs.

4. Workflow at a glance

UPLOAD invoice(s) → REVIEW line items & tariff codes → TAXES: enter freight / charges / exchange rate → SEND tax advice (email or WhatsApp) → optional: ASYCUDA entry · Brokerage fee quote

Most shipments follow this path. Manual entry is used when you have no invoice document or need to add a few items quickly.

5. Upload — supplier invoices

5.1 Supported files

- **PDF** — single or multi-page; multiple invoices in one PDF are split automatically
- **Images** — JPG, PNG, WEBP (scanned invoices)
- Maximum file size: approximately 10 MB

5.2 Steps

1. Go to the **Upload** tab.
2. Drag and drop a file onto the drop zone, or click to browse.
3. Wait while DutyDesk: reads the file → extracts line items → matches the tariff database → classifies remaining items with AI.
4. You are taken automatically to **Review** when processing completes.

5.3 Multiple invoices

If a PDF contains more than one invoice (different invoice numbers or layouts), each appears as a separate entry in Review. The filename shows a tag such as *invoice.pdf · INV-12345*.

Tip: For best scan results, use clear, straight photos with all columns visible — especially the line **extension/total** column on the right.

6. Review & classify line items

6.1 Invoice sidebar

Select an invoice from the left panel. Use + **Add Invoice** to upload more files.

6.2 Invoice details

Edit supplier name, invoice number, date, ship-from/to, currency, and exchange rate if needed.

- **Currency** — set if the invoice is not in USD (EUR, GBP, CAD, CNY, TTD).
- **Rate (1 CUR = TT\$)** — required for non-USD invoices before tax calculation.

6.3 Line item table

Hover column headers for explanations. Key columns:

Column	Action
Description	Click to edit if AI misread the product name.
T&T Tariff Code	Edit directly, pick from similar codes, or re-classify with AI (↻ button).
Source	Official = database match · AI est. = verify at ttbizlink.gov.tt
Qty / Unit Price / Total	Should match the supplier invoice. Total uses the printed line extension when available.

6.4 Export from Review

- **Export CSV** — spreadsheet of line items with tariff codes
- **Export Report** — printable tariff classification report with your clerk name

7. Manual entry

Use when you need to classify items without a full invoice upload.

1. Go to **Manual**.
2. Type a product description — the tariff database is searched as you type.
3. Select a match from the dropdown, or click + **Add Item** to use AI classification.
4. Enter quantity, unit, and unit price (USD).

Items attach to the currently selected invoice, or a new *Quick Entry* list is created.

8. Tax calculator

8.1 Select invoice(s)

- Choose one invoice from the dropdown, or check **Combine all invoices** to calculate multiple shipments together.
- For non-USD invoices, confirm currency and TT\$ exchange rate are set.

8.2 Customs tax inputs

Field	Description
Invoice Total (Auto)	Sum of classified line items (converted to USD if needed).
Freight	International shipping — added to CIF.
Insurance	Cargo insurance — added to CIF.
Exchange Rate	Customs rate: 1 USD = TT\$. Up to 5 decimal places. Blank uses team default.
Container Size	20ft (TT\$750) or 40ft (TT\$1,050) CES exam fee, if applicable.
User Fee	TT\$80 UFC fee when checked.
VAT Exempt	Check if entire shipment is VAT exempt.

8.3 Tax breakdown

The itemized table shows each line's share of CIF (TTD), duty, and VAT. Use checkboxes to mark individual lines as duty-exempt or VAT-exempt. Override duty/VAT manually in Tax Advice Details if

needed.

8.4 Consignee

Click **Manage** to add or edit consignees (name, email, phone, address, BIR code). Consignee records sync across the team. The consignee name must appear on certified cheques.

9. Freight, insurance & other charges

On the Taxes tab, use the two sub-tabs under Customs Tax Inputs:

Freight & Insurance

Enter amounts detected on the invoice or type manually. Values feed into CIF calculation.

Other Charges

Sales tax, VAT/GST on the invoice, handling fees, and similar charges appear here when detected during upload. You can add or edit each charge and mark **Include in CIF** when the amount should be part of the customs value.

Charges detected at upload (freight, insurance, sales tax) are stored on the invoice and carry through to tax calculation automatically.

10. Invoice totals check

After upload, DutyDesk compares the **sum of line items** to the **goods subtotal or grand total** printed on the supplier invoice.

If totals do not match: A yellow warning appears on Review. Click **Review now** to see the difference. Fix missing lines, quantities, or prices before sending tax advice.

If you acknowledge the discrepancy after checking, click **I've reviewed — continue**. Tax advice may note that line items and invoice totals may not be in sync.

11. Sending tax advice

11.1 Prepare

1. Complete tax calculation on the **Taxes** tab.
2. Fill in Worksheet #, Bill of Lading, and commodity description.
3. Select the consignee (with email and/or phone).
4. Click **Send Tax Advice**.

11.2 Send modal options

- **Email** — sends from configured Gmail when direct send is enabled; otherwise opens your mail client with attachments.
- **WhatsApp** — when consignee phone is saved, opens WhatsApp with a summary; email may send automatically first.
- **EC75 notice** — adds signing instructions for the EC75 form.
- **Tax calculation breakdown** — optional second attachment explaining CIF, duty, and VAT step by step.
- **Attachments** — add B/L, signed forms, or other PDFs manually.

11.3 Other exports

- **Print** — tax advice document for in-office use
- **Itemized Report** — detailed duty/VAT breakdown per line
- **Send to ASYCUDA** — passes approved figures to the ASYCUDA tab

Payment rules on the tax advice: under TT\$5,000 — cash or certified cheque; over TT\$5,000 — certified cheque only, payable to **THE COMPTROLLER OF CUSTOMS & EXCISE**.

12. Brokerage fees

The **Brokerage** tab estimates your brokerage service charges from CIF value, discount settings, and fee schedule. Use alongside tax calculation for a complete client quote.

13. ASYCUDA handoff

After approving tax figures on the Taxes tab, click **Send to ASYCUDA** →. The ASYCUDA tab receives line items with tariff codes, CIF (TTD/USD), duty, VAT, and consignee for customs entry preparation.

14. Learned classifications

When you confirm or correct a tariff code in Review, DutyDesk saves the description-to-code mapping for the whole team. Future uploads matching that description use the learned code automatically (**Learned** badge).

View and manage all learned entries on the **Learned** tab.

15. Reports & team sync

Every tax advice sent is logged on **Reports** with worksheet number, consignee, amounts, method (email/WhatsApp), and attachments. Logs sync to the shared database on login and when you send new advice.

Consignees and **exchange rate** also sync across clerks.

16. Admin — user accounts

Administrators can access the **Users** tab to:

- Create clerk and admin accounts
- Set display names (shown on tax advice and reports)
- Reset passwords

17. Tips & troubleshooting

Issue	What to do
Review tab is greyed out	Upload at least one invoice first.
AI classification fails	Check internet connection; contact admin if API key is not configured.
Line totals don't match invoice	Edit qty/prices in Review; check for missing lines or charges counted as products.
Non-USD invoice — wrong tax	Set invoice currency and TT\$ rate on Review or Taxes tab.
Exchange rate outdated	Enter current Customs Division rate on Taxes tab; optionally save as team default.
Email won't send directly	Admin must configure Google Apps Script webhook; use Mail App fallback.
Tariff code uncertain	Verify at ttbizlink.gov.tt HS Code Tariff Finder.
Previous user's data visible	Always sign out when leaving the workstation.

18. Glossary

Term	Meaning
CIF	Cost, Insurance & Freight — customs value basis (goods + freight + insurance + applicable charges).
ICD	Import Customs Duty.
VAT	Value Added Tax — 12.5% on CIF + duty (unless exempt).
CES	Container Examination System fee.
UFC	User Fee Charge — TT\$80 when applicable.
EC75	Customs declaration form — may require consignee signature.
ASYCUDA	Automated customs entry system used by T&T Customs.

Term	Meaning
Tariff code	Harmonized System code (e.g. 8708.99.00) determining duty rate.
Consignee	Importer of record — name must match certified cheque.